

How is ai actually using water

Posted by u/Illustrious_Rip1057 • 0 points • 3 comments

How is AI using water because I keep hearing that every five prompts is 16 oz basically a water bottle but then I also hear that they're reusing the water and people are saying that people that live near the data centers those people can't get water and I understand that AI uses a lot of electricity but then why can't people get clean water just doesn't make sense to me because if these data centers are reusing water like people are saying why are these people that live near data centers not getting any water?

Comments

u/FernandoMM1220 • 1 points • 2025-07-12 00:38 UTC

they're not using closed loop cooling like they're supposed to.

u/Astramancer_ • 1 points • 2025-07-11 19:35 UTC

Data centers usually use municipal water supplies. Once the water gets warm enough they need to discharge it and get new water since the whole point is to get rid of heat.

So they turn "treated" water into "untreated" water. Often times turning "aquifer" water into "surface" water, depending on the municipal water source.

The water isn't *gone* gone, but the usability is gone without extra work. Depending on where the data center is located, it could be gone effectively forever as it's discharged effectively straight into the ocean.

u/Illustrious_Rip1057 • 1 points • 2025-07-18 18:00 UTC

So since they turn the treated water into untreated water the city or whoever treats it has to treat it again so people can use it?

u/Astramancer_ • 1 points • 2025-07-18 18:07 UTC

Yes, which is added expense and infrastructure. Plus it's common for communities to get water from aquifer and discharge onto the surface, which further leads to draining the aquifer.

u/Illustrious_Rip1057 • 1 points • 2025-07-18 18:11 UTC

Ohh ty that makes more sense

u/Gravy_Sommelier • 2 points • 2025-07-11 19:21 UTC

The servers that run in big data centers generate a lot of heat. Cold water is pumped around them to cool them down. You can't take water from the ocean for this because the salt will ruin everything. Most places don't have a limitless supply of usable water to begin with, so that means less water available for drinking, farming, cleaning, etc.